Kameng Frontier Division where it was being placed under the command of 7 Infantry Brigade. Rikh protested that his battalion was not prepared to make such a drastic move. Having handed over charge to 6 Kumaon in Walong three months ago, the battalion was in Charduar where it was doing routine training before moving to its peacetime location. The men were not equipped with winter clothing. Apart from crucial items like radio sets, all they had on them were their personal weapons. Prasad, however, insisted that the battalion must move in the next few hours—the time of departure was set for 5 a.m. on 10 September. Transport was at that very moment being requisitioned by divisional staff and they were to get to Dirang Dzong, where they would receive further orders.

Out of an authorized strength of twenty-four officers, the battalion had only fourteen on its rolls; of these, the second-in-command (2IC), Major Gurdial Singh was on leave, Major Rajput, the Alpha Company commander, was on the Senior Officers' Course, Captain Raghbir Sain was on his way to Staff College, Captain Ashok Kalyan Verma was an instructor at the IMA, and Second Lieutenant Bhup Singh was on a Long Range Patrol in the Lohit Frontier Division. That the battalion managed to move at such short notice was a miracle and a lot of credit went to the acting 2IC, Major B. K. Pant.

Dalvi reached Tawang on 9 September and, with his staff, prepared his appreciation of the situation. The next day, Niranjan Prasad visited him, and using a sand model, they went over the various details pertaining to the tactical situation, the quantum of troops required and the logistical details. The assessment, based on the sand model discussion, was forwarded to Lieutenant General Umrao Singh, GOC XXXIII Corps, who in turn passed it on to Eastern Command, cautioning against mounting hasty operations in the Dhola region. Adding his views to Dalvi's appreciation, Umrao Singh said: 'Our ability to reinforce due to lack of troops and roads is limited. Our troops are on restricted scales of rations and have no reserves. Clothing is scanty for the extreme cold. We are short of ammunition and there [are] hardly any defence stores available. We also do not have adequate fire support.'

Umrao Singh further added that 'an attempt on our part to clear the Chinese south of Thagla Ridge will amount to an act of rashness'. To produce even a semblance of the resources required for this purpose, he would have to completely uncover Tawang and also withdraw troops from